

REFORM DEMOCRATS OF THE NEW COMMONWEALTH

ARA Policy Framework v26

Sourced-Evidence Edition

REF_RDNC_Framework_v26_Sourced_2026_5 · REF_ Reference Layer · Framework v26 · Scoring Methodology v1.1 · Source Reference Guide v11 · May 2026

65 Proposals	7.4 Average Score	3 Implementation Phases	370 Sources Cited
37 Phase I Day-1 to Year-2	21 Phase II Year-2 to Year-6	7 Phase III Year-6+	

This sourced edition provides axis-specific source citations for every proposal across all three scoring axes. **GP** citations identify the international precedent evidence base. **UT** citations identify the US implementation trajectory evidence. **B** citations identify the population-wide welfare outcome evidence. Source numbers are keyed to **REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11** (370 sources, 20 categories).

Score formula: $(GP + UT + B) / 1.5$ · **GP** = Global Precedent (1-5) · **UT** = US Transition Difficulty (1-5) · **B** = Societal Benefit (1-5). For full per-proposal scoring justification (195 structured paragraphs), see REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026. Scoring methodology: REF_RDNC_ScoringMethodology_2026 v1.1.

GP — Global Precedent	UT — US Transition Difficulty	B — Societal Benefit
5 Proven · 4 Strong · 3 Partial · 2 Limited · 1 Novel	5 Minimal · 4 Achievable · 3 Moderate · 2 High · 1 Extreme	5 Critical · 4 High · 3 Moderate · 2 Limited · 1 Minimal

ECONOMY & TAX REFORM

P1 — IRS Reform & Pre-Filed Taxes

Pre-calculate citizen tax liability; eliminate commercial tax prep industry dominance.

■ Bill 1 — COLT Act Title I

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Pre-filled returns standard in 85%+ of OECD administrations; 10+ Tier 1 nations with documented high-compliance, high-satisfaction outcomes; IRS Direct File pilot (296,531 users, 94% satisfaction) validates US feasibility. *Sources: 1, 2, 8.*

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★☆: Reconciliation vehicle (Bill 1); IRS demonstrated capacity via \$80B IRA appropriation; Direct File pilot confirmed scope, cost, and schedule targets; 2-3 year national rollout timeline with no structural barrier. *Sources: 2, 8, 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: ~150M filing households benefit; \$31.7B/yr in commercial prep costs eliminated; burden relief most progressive for lower-income filers (highest share of income spent on tax prep); enforcement ROI \$3.18-\$12 per \$1 invested. *Sources: 3, 5, 6, 7, 37.*

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 5 / UT 4 / B 4

P2 — Antitrust Enforcement & Corporate Accountability

Extend antitrust law to duopolies and captured markets; escalating criminal consequences for repeat violations.

■ Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Over 75% of US industries increased concentration over 20 years; EU DMA (2022) and German GWB §19a demonstrate structural remedy frameworks with documented deterrence; criminal executive liability for repeat violators has documented behavioral-change effect in European enforcement. *Sources: 64, 65, 66, 67.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: 60-vote Senate threshold applies to statutory criminal liability; executive enforcement posture (FTC/DOJ) can begin immediately; American Innovation and Choice Online Act (2022) stalled in Senate demonstrating political headwinds; 5-8 year timeline to structural market change. *Sources: 66, 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Anticompetitive markups cost workers \$1.4T annually in suppressed wages; consumers bear \$1.4T+ in excess rents across concentrated sectors; distributional impact progressive (lower-income households spend higher share of income in concentrated markets). *Sources: 67, 68, 69.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P3 — Ban Waste Export

Prohibit selling domestic waste and recyclables abroad; develop domestic solutions.

■ Executive — EPA rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Basel Convention Amendment (2019, 187 parties) prohibits OECD-to-non-OECD hazardous waste export; EU, UK, and Canada enforce domestic processing mandates; China's National Sword policy (2018) documented global market impact. *Sources: 196.*

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★☆: EPA statutory authority under RCRA provides implementation vehicle without new legislation; export restrictions on hazardous waste already in force; 3-5 year domestic infrastructure buildout is primary constraint; synergy with Bill 2/IIC capital investment. *Sources: 195.*

B [3 — Moderate] ★★★★★☆: Environmental benefit primarily accrues to export-destination nations (Indonesia, Malaysia, Vietnam); domestic geographic concentration of benefit near processing facilities; domestic job creation in waste processing sectors documented. *Sources: 162.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 4 / B 3

P4 — Close Wealth Accumulation Loopholes

Eliminate offshore accounts, shell corporations, and investment account loopholes enabling indefinite tax-deferred wealth

■ Bill 5 — BWDS Act Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: OECD FATF enforcement frameworks documented across Tier 1 nations; Tax Justice Network estimates \$427B in annual global tax revenue lost to offshore evasion; EU's ATAD I/II and FATF standards establish international compliance architecture. *Sources: 19, 194.*

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: Requires 60-vote Senate threshold; offshore enforcement requires multilateral cooperation with IRS data-sharing agreements; estimated 4–7 year implementation to meaningful offshore enforcement at scale; Moore v. United States (2024) constrains property-tax framing — income-inclusion approach more durable. *Sources: 3, 4, 20.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: \$160B+ annually in taxes top 1% choose not to pay; PWBM mark-to-market approach projected \$2.0–3.0T over 10 years; enforcement directly progressive — captures income that currently bypasses taxation at highest-wealth levels. *Sources: 3, 4, 15, 19.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 2 / B 5

P5 — Moving Minimum Wage (Fed-Managed)

Transfer minimum wage authority to Federal Reserve; tie wage floor to economic conditions.

■ Executive — Federal Reserve coordination

GP [2 — Limited] ★★☆☆☆: No Tier 1 comparator delegates minimum wage authority to central bank; economic-condition-indexed minimum wages exist in limited form (UK Low Pay Commission, some state automatic adjustment mechanisms); the specific Fed-managed design is novel without direct international analog. *Sources: 70, 71, 72.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Requires Federal Reserve Act amendment and legislative action; Dube-Lester-Reich and Cengiz et al. meta-analyses support economic-condition-indexed approach conceptually; 5+ year institutional design and implementation timeline; political difficulty high. *Sources: 70, 71, 72, 73.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: \$15/hr phase-in would raise wages for 17M workers; Dube-Lester-Reich county-pair analysis: near-zero employment effect in tight labor markets; Cengiz meta-analysis (138 state changes): documented wage gains with minimal job displacement; strongly progressive distribution. *Sources: 70, 71, 72, 73.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase II · GP 2 / UT 3 / B 5

P6 — Billionaire Wealth Tax & Digital Services Levy

Progressive annual tax on billionaire income on accrual basis; targeted levy on large digital services platforms.

■ Bill 5 — BWDS Act Titles I & II

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: PWBM Warren 2%/3% wealth tax projected \$2.1T conventional over 10 years; Saez-Zucman mark-to-market approach \$2.0–3.0T; France, Norway, Switzerland operate wealth tax variants; EU Digital Services Levy (2021 negotiations) precedent. *Sources: 14, 15, 19.*

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: Moore v. United States (2024) constrains net-worth property-tax framing; income-inclusion approach more constitutionally durable; 60-vote Senate threshold; billionaire lobbying and constitutional litigation risk are primary barriers; 5–8 year implementation even under favorable conditions. *Sources: 15, 20.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Top 1% pay estimated \$160B less annually than legally owed; mark-to-market taxation corrects the realization asymmetry that enables indefinite tax-deferred compounding; revenue directly finances healthcare, childcare, and infrastructure with documented progressive benefit. *Sources: 3, 4, 14, 15.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 2 / B 5

P7 — US Sovereign AI & Autonomous Systems Wealth Fund

Federally managed wealth fund capitalized through AI/autonomous systems licensing, taxation, and equity stakes.

■ Bill 10 — AIPE Act

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★☆☆: Norway Government Pension Fund Global (NBIM, \$1.78T as of 2024, authorized 1990) is the canonical model; 6.64% long-term average return at 0.04% management cost; governance: Ministry of Finance → Norges Bank mandate → NBIM execution. *Sources:* 286.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: NBIM took ~13 years from first inflows to \$1T — a realistic US sovereign fund timeline; AIPE Act Phase III preconditions required; requires statutory authorization with 60-vote threshold; capitalization through AI licensing and equity stakes is revenue-model novelty without direct precedent. *Sources:* 286.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Fund returns projected to finance healthcare, Social Security, Universal Basic Investment, and infrastructure; automation displacement creates long-term distributional pressure that sovereign fund returns can offset; universal distribution of AI productivity gains. *Sources:* 286, 131.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 5

HEALTHCARE & SOCIAL PROGRAMS

P8 — Restore Public Health Infrastructure & Biomedical Accountability

Restore ACIP statutory independence; return CDC/NIH funding to inflation-adjusted 2019 baseline; rebuild public health

■ Executive — HHS/CDC hybrid (Day 1 exec + Phase I legislation)

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: UK NICE, Germany RKI, France Santé Publique France, Australia ATAGI all operate with statutory independence and multi-year funding stability; OECD documents consistent correlation between infrastructure investment and population outcomes; US CDC was global leader through mid-2010s. *Sources:* 39, 192.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: Day 1 executive component (funding restoration, ACIP independence) requires no congressional action; legislative components (mandatory CDC Director confirmation, vaccination standards) require Phase I legislation; 1–3 year timeline to operational restoration; Yale Budget Lab documents \$600B deficit impact of IRS defunding — same root cause documented for CDC. *Sources:* 5, 54, 195.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: COVID-19 demonstrated the population-wide cost of infrastructure deterioration: CDC test failure (Feb 2020) attributable to budget cuts contributed to pandemic spread costing hundreds of thousands of lives; measles outbreak (4,000+ cases since Jan 2025, three deaths; CDC, 2026) is the current consequence of ACIP authority erosion; public health workforce shortfall ~80,000. *Sources:* 39, 40, 54, 192.

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 5

P9 — Socialized Public Childcare

Federally funded childcare accessible to all families, modeled on Nordic systems.

■ Bill 4 — FSW Act Title I

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: 41 high-income OECD and EU countries provide subsidized childcare; Germany and Estonia: net cost 0–1% of household wages; Quebec natural experiment (Baker-Gruber-Milligan, JPE 2008) is Tier A evidence; US has highest childcare costs as percentage of wages among OECD nations. *Sources: 42, 43, 44, 46.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: Reconciliation vehicle via Bill 4/FSW (IRC §21 structure); CBO BBB childcare score (\$381.5B gross over 6 years) establishes scoring precedent; 3–5 year to meaningful implementation; Connecticut, Vermont, and DC programs demonstrate state-level feasibility. *Sources: 44, 47.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Quebec: every \$1 invested returned \$1.49 to government; ~70,000 additional mothers employed, \$5.1B Quebec GDP impact (Fortin-Godbout-St-Cerny, 2013); affects 70%+ of families with children; strongly progressive burden relief — childcare costs represent highest share of income for lower-income working families. *Sources: 42, 44, 45, 46, 47.*

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase II · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 5

P10 — Universal Basic Investment for Children

Monthly investment credits for children ages 1–16; held in government bonds released at 18.

■ Bill 4 — FSW Act Title III

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★☆☆: Connecticut CT Baby Bonds (launched July 2023, ~13,300 enrolled in first 9 months at \$3,200/Medicaid birth) is the US analog; UK Child Trust Fund (2002–2011) and Singapore Baby Bonus demonstrate Tier 1 precedent for government-initiated child investment accounts. *Sources: 44, 287.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: Connecticut pilot confirms administrative feasibility; Urban Institute DYNASIM model: projected age-18 balances \$26K (Black), \$27K (Hispanic), \$18K (white), reducing white:Black wealth gap 2.4× to 2.1×; CRFB estimates federal cost ~\$60B/yr; 18-year outcome lag is UT constraint. *Sources: 287.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Expanded Child Tax Credit (2021) reduced child poverty 40%, lifting 3.7M children from poverty in first full month; universal baby bonds directly address intergenerational wealth gap; distributional impact maximally progressive — highest benefit to children born into lowest-wealth households. *Sources: 44, 48, 287.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 5

P11 — Non-Profit Prison System

Eliminate private prisons; nonprofit management of all facilities; expand mental and behavioral health programs.

■ Executive — DOJ + state incentives

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: US incarceration rate: 608 per 100,000 vs. OECD average ~120 per 100,000; all major Tier 1 comparators operate predominantly public, non-profit prison systems; DOJ rulemaking and contracting authority allow transition from private to non-profit management without new legislation. *Sources: 60, 61.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: Federal facilities (BOP): executive authority sufficient for contract non-renewal; state facilities require DOJ incentive grants and cooperative agreements; private prison contracts associated with higher incarceration rates per Vera Institute (2022); full transition 5–10 years. *Sources: 60, 61.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Private prisons have no documented cost savings after quality adjustment per Vera Institute; non-profit model with expanded mental/behavioral health programs reduces recidivism (documented in DOJ treatment program evaluations); distributional impact progressive — incarceration falls disproportionately on lower-income and minority populations. *Sources: 60, 61.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P12 — Drug Rescheduling & Harm Reduction

Regulated recreational/social drug schedule; enforce quality testing, taxation, and safe delivery research.

■ Executive — DEA/HHS rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Portugal decriminalization (2001) with harm reduction services documented 75% reduction in drug-related deaths; Netherlands, Switzerland, Canada supervised consumption sites; DEA partial final order (April 23, 2026) moved FDA-approved and state-medical marijuana to Schedule III — first US executive step. *Sources: 289.*

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: DEA administrative rescheduling of Schedule I substance: 32+ months from HHS recommendation to first partial order (August 2023 → April 2026), still incomplete; Trump EO 14370 (Dec 2025) directed expedited review but timeline remains uncertain; political reversal risk high. *Sources: 289.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Regulated recreational drug schedule with quality testing and taxation reduces overdose deaths, reduces incarceration for non-violent drug offenses, and generates state/federal tax revenue; harm reduction interventions have Tier A evidence for reducing HIV transmission and overdose mortality. *Sources: 289.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 2 / B 4

P13 — Universal Government-Funded Healthcare

Single-payer healthcare for all ages; funded by reallocating military budget and new revenue streams.

■ Bill 9 — UCT Act (Phase III; Bill 6 must operate 4+ years first)

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Implemented at national scale in all 16 Tier 1 comparators; US spends \$14,885/capita (17.2% of GDP) vs. OECD average \$5,967 (9.3%); every peer nation provides universal coverage at lower cost; Commonwealth Fund: US ranks last on equity, access, and efficiency. *Sources: 39, 40, 41, 55, 192.*

UT [1 — Extremely Hard] ★☆☆☆☆: Structural barrier: ERISA §502 coordination, provider rate-setting, private insurance elimination (\$1.1T annual premiums), 60-vote Senate threshold, and organized industry opposition combine to make transition genuinely structural rather than merely political; German multi-payer model is most feasible path; 7+ year phased implementation minimum; CBO single-payer: +\$1.5–3.0T federal subsidies in 2030 alone. *Sources: 55, 56, 57, 58.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Medical debt contributes to ~500,000 annual bankruptcies (Himmelstein et al., AJPH 2019); Sommers-Gawande-Baicker (NEJM 2012): Medicaid expansion reduced mortality 6.1%; universal coverage eliminates the coverage gaps, network inadequacy, and cost-sharing barriers that disproportionately burden lower-income Americans. *Sources: 39, 40, 41, 55.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase III · GP 5 / UT 1 / B 5

P14 — Bodily Autonomy Legal Framework

Federal bodily autonomy standard protecting abortion, contraception, gender-affirming care, and IVF from state compulsion.

■ Executive — Constitutional/judicial pathway

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: France amended constitution to protect abortion rights (March 2024); Canada Morgentaler (1988) constitutional protection; Germany §218 StGB parliamentary protection; most of Western Europe provides statutory or constitutional protection; WHO documents restrictions increase unsafe abortion rates. *Sources: 49, 50, 51, 52.*

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: Post-Dobbs constitutional landscape: federal statutory protection faces immediate challenge; interstate travel and commerce clause architecture requires doctrinal development; 60-vote Senate threshold; most durable protection requires constitutional amendment or significant Court composition change; UT=2 reflects statutory track feasibility under favorable conditions. *Sources: 49, 51, 53.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: ACOG documents abortion restrictions increase maternal mortality, complicate miscarriage and ectopic pregnancy care, and delay cancer treatment; IVF restrictions would eliminate ~75,000 births annually; Turnaway Study (Foster et al.): women denied abortions show worse economic, health, and child welfare outcomes across 5-year follow-up; gender-affirming care (Endocrine Society 2023) associated with significant mental health improvements. *Sources: 49, 50, 51, 52, 53.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase III · GP 4 / UT 2 / B 5

P15 — Social Security Modernization

Structural review integrating with Universal Basic Investment; reorient toward greatest need; ensure generational solvency.

■ Bill 9 — UCT Act (healthcare transition reduces SS burden)

GP [3 — Partial] ★★☆☆☆: Australia's superannuation system (mandatory employer contributions, government supplements) and Nordic multi-pillar pension systems demonstrate structural reform models; US-specific challenge — preserving earned-benefit covenant while integrating Universal Basic Investment — has limited direct peer analog. *Sources:* 62, 288.

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: SSA Trustees Report (2024): OASI depletion by FY2033; combined OASDI: 2034; post-depletion benefits 77% of scheduled; Social Security Fairness Act (2025) worsened trajectory \$195.7B/10yr; 60-vote threshold, AARP political mobilization, and cross-partisan constituent attachment make reform extremely politically constrained; 10+ year implementation. *Sources:* 62, 288.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: CBO: 75-year actuarial imbalance 4.3% of taxable payroll; solvency requires payroll tax increase from 12.4% to 16.2% or 24% benefit cut absent reform; reorientation toward greatest need would increase replacement rate for lowest-income retirees who currently receive smallest share of pre-retirement income; integration with Universal Basic Investment creates two-pillar retirement system. *Sources:* 62, 288.

Score: 6.0 / 10 · Phase III · GP 3 / UT 2 / B 4

DEMOCRACY & ELECTORAL REFORM

P16 — Address Gerrymandering

Federal districting standards for congressional elections; require uniformity in ranked-choice voting rules.

■ Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title V

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Australia Electoral Commission, Canada provincial boundary commissions, UK Boundary Commissions, and New Zealand Representation Commission all remove partisan control from districting; Arizona AIRC and California IIRC demonstrate US state-level feasibility; AIRC upheld in Arizona State Legislature v. AIRC (2015). *Sources:* 197.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Federal authority under Elections Clause (Art. I §4) for congressional elections is constitutionally established; Callais (3d Cir., April 2026) reinterpreted VRA §2 to require intentional discrimination proof, complicating enforcement but not Elections Clause authority; 30+ state transition requires either legislative compliance or federal enforcement; one redistricting cycle (2–3 years) for meaningful impact. *Sources:* 196, 197.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Competitive districts structurally increase constituent responsiveness; local newspaper closure studies (Rubado-Jennings 2020) document lower turnout and higher corruption in uncompetitive districts; every other ARA proposal's durability depends on Congress that faces real electoral accountability; distributional impact universal. *Sources:* 197.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P17 — National Voting Holiday

Establish Election Day as a federal holiday; consolidate minor federal holidays to maintain work-schedule neutrality.

■ Bill 1 — COLT Act Title IV

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: France, New Zealand, Australia designate election days as public holidays or hold elections on Sundays; OECD turnout data shows higher baseline participation in nations with weekend or holiday voting; 10+ Tier 1 comparators with documented structure. *Sources: 196, 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Achievable via simple majority legislation or executive proclamation — no structural barrier to enactment; but Audit 5 research found that federal holiday designation alone does not reach the 60–90% population affected threshold within 10 years because workers in retail, service, and healthcare (highest-turnout-suppression sectors) are least likely to observe the holiday. *Sources: 196.*

B [3 — Moderate] ★★★★★☆: Farber (2009, Princeton) found approximately zero statistically significant effect on voter turnout from Election Day federal holiday designation; policy retains real value as civic signal and marginal scheduling improvement for some workers, but the primary claimed mechanism (turnout increase) is not supported by Tier A evidence. *Sources: 196.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 3

P18 — Shutdown Accountability for Congress

Strip congressional salaries during shutdowns; require members to remain in DC until resolved.

■ Executive — House/Senate rules change

GP [2 — Limited] ★★☆☆☆☆: No Tier 1 comparator experiences government shutdowns as a routine legislative mechanism; parliamentary systems resolve budget standoffs through confidence votes, mandatory continuing resolutions (Germany, Australia), or automatic temporary spending authority; principle (legislators bear cost of failure) is universal but mechanism is US-specific structural outlier. *Sources: 196, 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: 27th Amendment constraints on pay reduction require prospective compensation forfeiture rather than retroactive reduction; House and Senate rules changes achievable by majority vote without presidential signature; primary political difficulty: the majority that changes the rules benefits from shutdown threats. *Sources: 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: 2018–2019 35-day shutdown: \$11B direct economic cost (OMB); 800,000+ workers affected; federal contractor harm and long-term recruitment damage documented; shutdown normalization degrades federal workforce capacity and public trust in government functioning. *Sources: 195.*

Score: 6.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 2 / UT 3 / B 4

P19 — Restore Independent Local News & Media Ownership Standards

Restore CPB funding; reinstate FCC ownership caps; mandatory local news production minimums; editorial/ownership

■ Executive — FCC rulemaking + CPB funding restoration

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: BBC (UK), CBC (Canada), ABC (Australia), ARD/ZDF (Germany), NRK (Norway) demonstrate well-documented public media models; EU Media Freedom Act (2024) establishes ownership concentration limits; FCC broadcast ownership caps (1975-2003) represent prior US domestic standard — restoration is reversion, not novelty. *Sources: 196, 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: FCC rulemaking to reinstate ownership caps is within existing statutory authority; CPB funding restoration (~\$500M/yr) achievable through reconciliation; structural editorial separation requirements face First Amendment challenge but commercial speech and broadcast licensing frameworks provide footing; 3-5 year timeline for market structural change. *Sources: 195, 196.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Northwestern Local News Initiative: 2,500+ newspapers closed since 2005; Rubado-Jennings (Political Research Quarterly, 2020): local newspaper closure associated with lower voter turnout, higher corruption; Gao et al. (Journal of Finance, 2020): municipal borrowing costs increase after local newspaper closure; democratic accountability infrastructure is at stake. *Sources: 196.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P20 — Fraud & Foreign Interference Enforcement Act

Legal definitions and criminal penalties for coordinated domestic fraud and foreign-linked disinformation; narrowly scoped to

■ Executive — DOJ/FBI + FTC coordination

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: EU Digital Services Act (2022) establishes platform accountability for disinformation; Germany NetzDG (2017) criminalizes coordinated inauthentic behavior at scale; UK Online Safety Act (2023) creates platform liability for coordinated harms; US DOJ has existing authority under FARA and computer fraud statutes. *Sources: 131, 138.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: DOJ and FBI enforcement under existing FARA, computer fraud, and election interference statutes can begin immediately; new statutory criminal penalties for coordinated domestic fraud require legislation; First Amendment constraints require narrow scoping to avoid overbreadth; 3-5 year timeline for full statutory and enforcement infrastructure. *Sources: 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Foreign-linked disinformation campaigns (documented in 2016, 2018, 2020, 2022, 2024 election cycles) impose welfare costs on democratic decision-making; domestic coordinated fraud causes direct economic harm; enforcement deters future interference with democratic institutions. *Sources: 196, 197.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P21 — National Firearm Standards Framework (Two-Track)

Track A: existing state hunting/sporting licenses for manual-action long guns. Track B: Federal Civilian Ownership Certificate

■ Bill 12 — NFSA full two-track architecture

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Maryland Firearm Safety Act (2013): Crifasi (2017) 82% reduction in firearm diversion indicators in Baltimore; Doucette (2024): 32.3% reduction in firearm injury hospitalization rates; NFA eForms system achieves 4–10 day processing turnaround, demonstrating federal firearms processing feasibility. *Sources:* 294, 295.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: Track B (FCOC) is constitutionally achievable post-Bruen — history and tradition of licensing for dangerous activities supports certification framework; ATF eForms demonstrates 65,000–80,000 applications/month processing capacity; Maryland HQL implementation: 3–4 years from enactment to measured outcome; 5–8 year timeline to full FCOC compliance. *Sources:* 294, 295, 296.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: RAND Gun Policy in America (2024): Tier A evidence for licensing requirements reducing firearm homicide and suicide in states with licensing vs. non-licensing; FCOC compliance reaches ~65M annual acquisition events; Track A preserves existing state-administered hunting/sporting licenses — no disruption to existing lawful users. *Sources:* 294, 295, 296.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

LEGAL & GOVERNANCE

P22 — Citizen Data Ownership Laws

Data fiduciary standard: companies hold user data in trust with duties of care, loyalty, and confidentiality. Consent and

■ Bill 7 — DRDO Act Titles I-IV

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: EU GDPR (2018) establishes fiduciary-standard data protection with documented compliance effects: documented reduction in data broker activity, behavioral changes in platform consent architecture; California CCPA/CPRA, UK GDPR, Canada PIPEDA, Japan APPI, South Korea PIPA all provide national frameworks. *Sources:* 131, 138.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: Federal data privacy legislation stalled 10+ years; but bipartisan agreement on need for federal standard increased post-Loper Bright (2024) given weakened Chevron deference making rulemaking less reliable; Bill 7/DRDO provides statutory framework with FTC enforcement; 60-vote threshold; 3–5 year compliance infrastructure buildout. *Sources:* 131, 138, 293.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Data extraction harms documented: manipulative advertising targeting vulnerable populations, discriminatory algorithmic decision-making in housing and credit, surveillance enabling IPV; harm concentration in lower-income, lower-education, and minority populations; baseline consent and fiduciary protection is foundational to digital participation. *Sources:* 131, 138.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P23 — Ban Congressional Insider Trading

Prohibit members of Congress from trading individual securities while in office; mandatory blind trusts; criminal penalties and

■ Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title I

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK Parliamentary Standards Act, Canadian MP conflict rules, Australian Ministerial Standards, EU institutional integrity frameworks all restrict official trading and require disclosure; STOCK Act (2012) provides US statutory basis — gap is enforcement, not authority. *Sources: 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Constitutional framework sound (Brewster 1972, Gravel 1972 establish Speech or Debate Clause does not protect securities trading); Bill 3/ACFM strengthens penalties and establishes blind trust requirements beyond STOCK Act; 60-vote threshold; 2022 House-passed bill stalled in Senate demonstrating political headwinds. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Members with personal investment in regulated sectors have documented structural conflict of interest; mandatory blind trusts eliminate ongoing conflict; disgorgement and criminal penalties provide deterrence; democratic legitimacy benefit from eliminating appearance of self-dealing. *Sources: 196, 197.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P24 — Higher Standards & Accountability for Officials

Stiffer criminal penalties for crimes committed in office; no plea bargains or reduced charges for politicians.

■ Bill 3 — ACFM Act Titles I-II

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK Bribery Act (2010) strict liability for official corruption; Germany StGB Amtsmisbrauch mandatory penalties; France HATVP mandatory personal asset disclosure; Transparency International Corruption Perceptions Index documents strong correlation between accountability frameworks and lower corruption. *Sources: 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Enhanced criminal penalties for official misconduct require legislation (Bill 3/ACFM); Brewster establishes criminal prosecution does not implicate Speech or Debate Clause for trading conduct; broader constituent and public support than insider trading ban makes political passage more achievable. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: World Bank Governance Indicators document correlation between rule of law (including official accountability) and economic development, public service delivery quality, and investment; adverse selection reduction (self-interested actors less likely to seek office when consequences are high). *Sources: 197.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P25 — Full Financial Transparency for Presidents

Eliminate privacy protections on presidential investments, finances, and healthcare records while in office.

■ Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title II

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★★★☆: France HATVP requires full asset disclosure for presidential candidates; Canada ethics commissioner has Prime Ministerial jurisdiction; Germany ministerial disclosure; no peer nation has faced the specific US situation of a president with large, publicly visible private business empire managed while in office. *Sources: 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Trump v. Mazars (2020) established four-factor balancing test; statutory mandatory disclosure as condition of public office is constitutionally distinguishable from subpoena power; Duplantier v. United States (5th Cir. 1979) upheld mandatory disclosure for federal officials; novel Article II questions counsel external legal review before introduction. *Sources: 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Documented conflicts in Trump administrations (tariffs, regulatory enforcement, foreign engagement decisions proximate to presidential financial interests); transparency enables Congressional, judicial, and public accountability for apparent conflicts; mechanism is accountability-enabling. *Sources: 197.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 4

P26 — Bipartisan Oversight of Detention Facilities

Migrant facilities managed by balanced party committee; mandatory rotating congressional inspections.

■ Executive — EO + congressional directive

GP [2 — Limited] ★★☆☆☆: EU Reception Conditions Directive standards and independent monitoring bodies across member states provide accountability precedent; bipartisan committee structure for detention oversight is structurally novel among Tier 1 comparators whose parliamentary systems provide oversight through different mechanisms. *Sources:* 132.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Partial implementation via executive order (mandatory inspection schedules, reporting requirements for privately managed facilities); full statutory bipartisan committee structure requires legislation; DHS rulemaking can establish facility standards within existing authority. *Sources:* 132, 195.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: DHS OIG (2019–2024) documented inadequate medical care, overcrowding, and in-custody deaths (41 in 2022, highest recorded); ~40,000 individuals in daily detention; facility conditions affect detainee capacity to participate in immigration proceedings with documented case outcome effects. *Sources:* 132.

Score: 6.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 2 / UT 3 / B 4

P27 — Restrict Corporate Home Ownership

Ban corporations from owning vacant single-family homes; progressive property taxation on residential holdings beyond two

■ Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I

GP [3 — Partial] ★★☆☆☆: Canada Prohibition on Purchase by Non-Canadians Act (2023); Australia planning approval requirements; New Zealand Overseas Investment Act (2018 amendments); EU member states emerging restrictions; domestic corporate (vs. foreign) single-family acquisition restrictions are more novel. *Sources:* 133, 134.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Bill 8/HCI provides statutory vehicle; Takings Clause and Due Process constraints limit retroactive application but permit prospective prohibition; incentive-based state adoption achievable through reconciliation funding; direct federal prohibition requires 60-vote threshold; private equity real estate lobby significant. *Sources:* 133, 134, 196.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Harvard JCHS (2024): 12.1 million renter households severely cost-burdened; institutional investors own up to 40% of single-family rental homes in some submarkets; NLIHC: 7.3M affordable home shortage; corporate ownership displaces first-time buyers from primary wealth-building mechanism. *Sources:* 133, 134.

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 4

P28 — Stricter Advertising Laws

Truth-in-advertising standards modeled on Japanese law; strict limits on advertising targeting children under 16.

■ Bill 7 — DRDO Act Title II + Title V

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Japan JFTC truth-in-advertising enforcement with documented compliance effects is direct model; UK HFSS ad ban (9pm watershed + 24hr online: enforcement January 2026, estimated 20,000 fewer childhood obesity cases); EU Unfair Commercial Practices Directive; Quebec consumer protection advertising ban (1978, 45+ years of evidence). *Sources:* 143, 144, 145.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: FTC rulemaking averages 5+ years ANPR-to-final; Click-to-Cancel rule (Oct 2024) was vacated by 8th Circuit (July 8, 2025); Commercial Surveillance ANPR stalled 3.7+ years; statutory authority via Bill 7/DRDO is more durable path; 60-vote threshold; Central Hudson framework permits reasonable restrictions on false/misleading commercial speech. *Sources:* 293.

B [3 — Moderate] ★★☆☆☆: Children's advertising restrictions have documented welfare effects (Quebec ban: Dhar-Baylis reduced fast-food purchase propensity 13%/week; Boyland meta-analysis: 96 studies confirm food marketing increases caloric intake); adult truth-in-advertising provides real but diffuse consumer welfare protection; below Moderate because primary mechanism affects a subset of advertising. *Sources:* 143, 144, 145.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 3

P29 — Age & Term Limits for Officials

Maximum age caps for all three branches; term limits for Supreme Court justices via senior status model.

■ Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Germany Constitutional Court: single 12-year terms; Spain Constitutional Court: single 9-year terms; France Constitutional Council: single 9-year terms; no Tier 1 comparator with similar constitutional review function uses life tenure. *Sources: 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: Term limits for Article III judges face 'good behaviour' clause challenge; senior status model (active→senior after 18 years) is most constitutionally defensible statutory path; age caps for legislators require constitutional amendment for Congress but are achievable via party rule for caucus membership; litigation will follow any statutory implementation. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Life tenure creates judicial accountability deficit; no other Tier 1 comparator with judicial review uses life tenure; polling consistently shows 70%+ public support for age limits; senior status model maintains expertise while introducing democratic renewal. *Sources: 197.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P30 — AI Safety & Rights Framework

Laws governing AI safety standards, liability, and the legal status of AI systems and the companies that build and operate them. Includes human rights to AI access as a corollary commitment.

■ Reserved for Human Drafting (deliberately not yet drafted)

This proposal is held as a policy commitment without accompanying bill text. The reservation is deliberate. AI safety, AI liability, AI legal status, and human rights to AI access are substantive subjects that warrant direct human authorship rather than AI-assisted drafting. The RDNC's working position is that legislation governing the regulator-regulated relationship between AI systems and the humans they affect should be developed by human policymakers — drawing on public consultation, lived-experience perspectives, AI-skeptical and AI-critical voices, and licensed legislative counsel — without an AI system shaping its priors during the drafting phase.

The proposal therefore appears in this Framework as a Reserved Proposal: a policy commitment visible in the platform, with bill content intentionally left to be built out by human policymakers at a later date. This is a structural decision, not a deferral of priority. AI safety and rights legislation remain a primary commitment of the platform.

Score and phase carried forward from earlier Framework editions for navigational continuity (GP 2 / UT 3 / B 4 → 6.0/10, Phase II); these reflect the proposal's analytical position prior to the reservation decision and remain instructive for sequencing purposes.¹

¹ See REF_RDNC_Leg11_Bill10_AIPE SPECIAL SITUATION DISCLOSURE for the related disclosure on AI-assisted drafting of fiscal-capture provisions targeting the AI sector. The two disclosures address adjacent but distinct ethical questions.

Score: 6.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 2 / UT 3 / B 4 (navigational, not implementation guidance)

P31 — Patent Law Reform

Reduce effective patent exclusivity periods; clearer compulsory licensing pathways; address evergreening practices.

■ Executive — Commerce/USPTO rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: EU pharmaceutical patent compulsory licensing under TRIPS Article 31; Australia Pharmaceutical Benefits Scheme reference pricing; Canada Patented Medicine Prices Review Board; UK NICE cost-effectiveness thresholds — all constrain evergreening and reduce effective monopoly periods. *Sources: 196.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: USPTO rulemaking authority for patent claim construction and continuation practice reform is within existing statutory authority; compulsory licensing pathway expansion requires legislation; evergreening restrictions face TRIPS compliance requirements; pharmaceutical industry opposition significant. *Sources: 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: I-MAK (2022): top 12 drugs by revenue cost \$96B/year in excess pricing from evergreening; shorter effective patent periods reduce drug costs for consumers and government programs; compulsory licensing for high-public-value patents directly reduces cost of medications bearing the highest burden on lower-income patients. *Sources: 196.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P32 — Repeal / Reform Citizens United

Limit corporate money in politics via legislation or constitutional amendment; regulate lobbying.

■ Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK Electoral Commission: strict third-party spending limits; Germany Parteiengesetz: contribution limits and transparency requirements; Canada Elections Act: strict third-party advertising expenditure limits; France: corporate campaign contributions prohibited entirely; US is structural outlier after Citizens United + McCutcheon. *Sources: 197.*

UT [1 — Extremely Hard] ★☆☆☆☆: Citizens United is a First Amendment constitutional decision; overturning via legislation requires Supreme Court reversal or constitutional amendment (two-thirds of Congress + 38 states); current Court composition shows no appetite for reconsideration; Track A (enhanced disclosure, foreign corporation prohibitions) is achievable by statute but does not fully address Citizens United holding. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Corporate campaign expenditure is the primary mechanism by which private economic power translates into legislative outcomes; documented correlation between corporate PAC activity and legislative voting records on taxation, regulation, pharmaceutical pricing; unlimited expenditure concentrates political influence in proportion to wealth, directly inverting democratic equality principle. *Sources: 197.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase III · GP 4 / UT 1 / B 5

P33 — Supreme Court Reform

Restore ideological balance; impose term limits via senior status model; expand authority to curtail executive overreach.

■ Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title II

GP [3 — Partial] ★★☆☆☆: Germany Constitutional Court: single 12-year terms mandatory retirement at 68; Spain Constitutional Court: single 9-year terms; France Constitutional Council: single 9-year terms; no Tier 1 comparator with constitutional review function uses life tenure — US is a structural outlier. *Sources: 197.*

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: 'Good behaviour' clause (Art. III §1) creates constitutional challenge for statutory term limits; senior status model (active→senior at 18 years) is most constitutionally defensible path and may be achievable by statute; court expansion requires only legislation but faces strong political norm against 'court-packing'; UT=2 because senior status model may be achievable in favorable conditions. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Post-Dobbs, post-Loper Bright Court has demonstrated that life-tenure justices appointed by minority-popular-vote presidents can eliminate 50-year constitutional rights and reshape the administrative state; term limits align judicial tenure with democratic accountability; Court composition determines constitutional space for every other ARA proposal. *Sources: 196, 197.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase III · GP 3 / UT 2 / B 5

P34 — Reduce Tuition & Expand Adult Education

Cap and reduce college tuition; tie unemployment benefits to free vocational or behavioral health enrollment.

■ Bill 4 — FSW Act Title II

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Germany's dual apprenticeship system (50%+ of students, longitudinal employment outcome data: Tier A); Denmark, Finland, Sweden: universal adult vocational retraining programs tied to employment transitions; Germany eliminated university tuition nationally (2014); OECD Education at a Glance documents per-student outcomes. *Sources: 135, 290.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Title IV funding conditions (South Dakota v. Dole constitutional authority) allow federal tuition cap leverage; Tennessee Promise (150,000+ enrolled, \$4,537/student/yr community college, all-time high 83.8% first-to-second semester success in 2024) is strongest US analog; 28 state promise programs confirm scaling model; 5-10 year federal scaling timeline. *Sources: 135, 290, 291.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: \$1.7T outstanding student debt; average \$37,000 per graduate; adult vocational retraining directly addresses workforce displacement; Tennessee Promise data: scalable at ~\$4,500/student/yr; burden relief most progressive for graduates from lower-income families with highest debt-to-income ratios. *Sources: 135, 136, 290.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P35 — Digital Minor Protection Standards (Three-Tier)

Platform-level accountability: under-13 no access without verified parental consent; 13–15 chronological feeds only; 16–17

■ Bill 7 — DRDO Act Title V

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK Children's Code (2021) restricts behavioral profiling, targeted advertising, and nudge techniques for users under 18; EU Digital Services Act (2022) minor protection provisions; three-tier structure in DRDO Act Title V modeled directly on UK Children's Code with demonstrated architecture. *Sources: 138.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: FTC enforcement authority via Bill 7/DRDO provides statutory vehicle; COPPA established that Congress can regulate children's online activity; platform technical compliance (age verification, algorithmic feed architecture) is the primary 3–5 year implementation challenge; 60-vote threshold applies. *Sources: 138, 293.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★★: Haidt (The Anxious Generation, 2024) documents causal link between social media use and adolescent mental health decline; Boyland meta-analysis: 96 studies confirm food marketing increases caloric intake for minors; algorithmic exploitation of developmental vulnerability is documented at scale; three-tier architecture protects under-13 absolutely while preserving older teen agency with defaults. *Sources: 138, 143, 144.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P36 — Shift Corporate Role from Healthcare to Training

Remove corporate healthcare obligations; create tax incentives for corporations to fund employee training.

■ Bill 4 — FSW Act Title IV

GP [2 — Limited] ★★☆☆☆☆: OECD Getting Skills Right (2019): firms in countries where healthcare is publicly provided invest more in worker training; German employer training investment substantially exceeds US average; but specific policy mechanism (removing healthcare obligation to reallocate to training) has no direct Tier 1 analog — most comparators operate both systems simultaneously. *Sources: 81, 82.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: JCT: employer health insurance exclusion is 3rd-largest federal tax expenditure at \$252.4B; WOTC authorization expired Dec 31, 2025, pending reauthorization; Registered Apprenticeship +114% in 10 years is realistic US workforce scaling benchmark; 60-vote threshold; healthcare industry resistance significant; 5–10 year transition. *Sources: 21, 80, 81, 291.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: US employers spend avg \$20,143/worker on family health insurance vs. \$1,054–1,254/worker on training — a 12–16× disparity; Registered Apprenticeship: average entry wage \$18/hr, exit \$32/hr (+77%), lifetime earnings premium >\$240K; workforce retraining reduces displacement harm for workers in declining industries. *Sources: 80, 81, 82, 291.*

Score: 6.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 2 / UT 3 / B 4

P37 — Adopt Scandinavian Education Model

Overhaul K-12 toward Nordic best practices; hands-on learning; reduce screen time under-16; teacher professionalization.

■ Executive — DOE rulemaking + state incentives (Phase III)

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Finland: consistent top-tier PISA performance with near-zero achievement gap; US ranks 28th reading, 35th mathematics among OECD; McKinsey (2009): closing US achievement gap would add 3–5% GDP annually; all Nordic nations document superior outcomes relative to US per-student spending. *Sources:* 135, 136, 137.

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★★☆☆☆: K-12 is constitutionally state function; federal lever (Title I, IDEA, ESSA) is incentive-based and constitutionally constrained post-NFIB v. Sebelius; teacher professionalization to Scandinavian level (graduate-degree entry, high salary, high social status) requires 15–20 year pipeline; 300,000 unfilled teaching positions nationally is starting-point deficit; 50-state adoption required. *Sources:* 135, 136.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Educational outcomes are highest-leverage determinants of lifetime welfare: Chetty et al. Opportunity Insights documents causal relationship between teacher quality and lifetime earnings; Goldin-Katz documents education as primary driver of productivity growth; Finland's documented success closing achievement gaps across income levels is the welfare case — replication at US scale would be generational. *Sources:* 135, 136, 137.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase III · GP 5 / UT 2 / B 5

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

P38 — Renewable & Nuclear Energy Investment

Major public investment in solar, wind, hydroelectric, and thorium nuclear; infrastructure standards resilient through

■ Bill 2 — IIC Act Titles I & II

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: EU Green Deal (€600B, 2021–2030), Germany Energiewende (80% renewable target by 2030), France nuclear fleet (70%+ of electricity), Denmark (50%+ wind generation), Japan Green Transformation; IEA (2024): renewables = 90% of new global electricity capacity additions; solar LCOE declined 90% (2010–2023). *Sources:* 26, 34, 35.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Reconciliation vehicle (no 60-vote threshold); IRA (2022) established investment framework — this proposal extends and scales; physical grid constraint: US permitting for major transmission projects averages 7+ years; thorium nuclear carries additional technical uncertainty (no commercial scale deployment in Tier 1 comparators). *Sources:* 26, 34, 35.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory (2024): IRA-driven solar/wind now lowest-cost new electricity in most US regions; DOE (2024): 80% clean electricity by 2035 reduces consumer costs up to \$500/household/yr; IRA manufacturing credits support 279,000 jobs by 2030; IPCC AR6: clean energy transition is the single highest-impact climate mitigation pathway. *Sources:* 26, 34, 35.

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 5

P39 — Restore & Expand Federal Inspectors

Dramatically increase federal auditors and inspectors to restore corporate and governmental accountability.

■ Bill 2 — IIC Act Title IV

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK HSE, Germany Bundesbehörden, France inspection régimes maintain inspector-to-regulated-entity ratios substantially exceeding current US levels; OECD Regulatory Policy Outlook documents peer nations maintain consistent enforcement staffing as core public administration function. *Sources:* 5, 195.

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★☆: Within executive authority and Bill 2/IIC appropriations authorization; OPM hiring averages 101 days job-announcement to hire; OSHA inspector training ~5 years; pipeline can be launched immediately but operational capacity builds over 3–5 years; Yale Budget Lab: reducing IRS staffing 28,000 increases deficit ~\$600B/10yr — same root cause for inspection capacity erosion. *Sources:* 5, 195, 276.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Haviland-Burns-Gray (NBER, 2010): OSHA inspections reduce injuries 9.4% and workers' compensation costs 26% over 4+ years with no employment effect; GAO High Risk List documents inspection capacity gaps across food safety, workplace safety, and environmental enforcement; distributional impact progressive — lower-wage workers in agriculture/construction/food processing bear highest enforcement gap burden. *Sources:* 5, 195, 276.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 4 / B 4

P40 — Shoreline & Fishery Protection

Protected shorelines, sustainable fisheries, and aquaculture investment; moratorium on mass seafloor mining pending

■ Executive — NOAA/EPA rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Norway ITQ fishery management system is the international reference for sustainable catch management; EU Common Fisheries Policy with documented stock recovery outcomes; Australia GBRMPA integrated marine protection model; Marine Protected Areas with adequate enforcement show documented biodiversity and catch recovery in adjacent areas. *Sources:* 163.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: NOAA Status of Stocks (2023): ~2 stock rebuilds/yr since 2000; rebuilding plans typically exceed 10 years for depleted stocks; no NOAA implementation trajectory evidence for reaching 60–90% population within 10 years; seafloor mining moratorium requires executive order (vulnerable to reversal) or legislation; ecological recovery timeline is the binding UT constraint. *Sources:* 163.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: NOAA: ocean-based industries \$373B to US GDP annually; 46 stocks subject to overfishing or overfished; shoreline ecosystem services (storm surge mitigation, carbon sequestration, wildlife habitat) have documented monetized value; coastal fishing communities bear concentrated economic harm from stock depletion. *Sources:* 163.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P41 — Strategic Domestic Technology Investment

Substantially expand federal investment in domestic semiconductor fabrication and next-generation battery technology.

■ Bill 2 — IIC Act Title II

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Taiwan TSMC (government-linked public-private semiconductor dominance); South Korea Samsung/SK Hynix state-directed investment; EU Chips Act (2023, €43B); Japan semiconductor reinvestment program; SIA (2021): concentration of advanced semiconductor production in Taiwan is documented supply chain vulnerability. *Sources:* 278.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Reconciliation vehicle (extends CHIPS Act framework); primary constraint is physical — semiconductor fab construction takes 5–7 years groundbreaking to production; CHIPS R&D; workforce development requires specialized training pipelines; timeline to meaningful domestic production capacity is at outer edge of Phase I window. *Sources:* 278.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: 2021–2022 chip shortage: ~\$240B in lost US manufacturing output (Chicago Fed estimate); contributed to inflation across multiple consumer sectors; battery technology cost reduction accelerates clean energy deployment (P38 compounding effect); domestic capacity reduces adversarial supply chain leverage over defense and consumer technology systems. *Sources:* 278.

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 5

P42 — Cooperative Mining with Allied Nations

Joint mineral extraction agreements with allies to reduce adversary supply chain dependence.

■ Executive — State Department

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: US-Australia Critical Minerals Partnership, EU Critical Raw Materials Act (2023), Japan-Australia critical minerals cooperation, G7 Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment all represent documented allied-nation supply chain collaboration frameworks with active implementation. *Sources:* 196.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Bilateral cooperation agreements within State Department executive authority; major extraction treaty frameworks require Senate two-thirds ratification; partner-nation extraction capacity expansion requires private investment alongside government frameworks; meaningful supply chain diversification takes 7+ years. *Sources:* 196.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: China dominates processing of cobalt, lithium, and rare earths — strategic leverage over electric vehicles, clean energy systems, and defense electronics; supply chain diversification reduces cost volatility and adversarial leverage; secondary benefit: environmental and labor standard conditions in allied-nation agreements. *Sources:* 196.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P43 — Modernize Airports & Air Traffic Control

Capital investment in airports; hire and train more air traffic controllers; restructure TSA.

■ Bill 2 — IIC Act Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Germany Fraport, France ADP, Singapore Changi, Japan NARITA demonstrate government-led airport infrastructure excellence; EU SESAR mandates member-state ATC modernization; peer nations maintain lower delay rates and higher efficiency metrics than current US system. *Sources:* 146, 195.

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★☆: Bill 2/IIC appropriations authorization; FAA statutory authority established; but FAA NextGen program: \$15B+ spent, ~16% of projected benefits delivered as of 2025, completion projected 2030+; UT=4 maintained because legislative/funding mechanism is achievable — implementation constraint is managerial not structural. *Sources:* 272, 195.

B [3 — Moderate] ★★☆☆☆: Primary beneficiaries are frequent air travelers (disproportionately higher-income) and cargo efficiency; FAA documented implementation efficiency problem (16% of NextGen projected benefits delivered) moderates near-term benefit confidence; infrastructure maintenance value is real but welfare distribution is less progressive than most Phase I proposals. *Sources:* 272, 195.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 4 / B 3

P44 — Electrify & Modernize USPS

Convert USPS fleet to electric; prepare for next-generation delivery; restore operating budget.

■ Bill 2 — IIC Act Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Germany Deutsche Post DHL, France La Poste, UK Royal Mail all pursuing or achieving partial fleet electrification; Biden EO requiring 100% EV federal vehicle purchases by 2035 established policy direction; USPS NGDV contract with Oshkosh Defense provides implementation framework. *Sources:* 273.

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★: Bill 2/IIC provides appropriations authorization; USPS has statutory authority and began NGDV execution; but USPS NGDV: ~9 years from program initiation to ~2,500 vehicles (Nov 2025, ~3% of fleet), 3× cost estimate; UT=4 maintained because legislative mechanism is clear — pace requires acceleration to achieve meaningful fleet transition within term. *Sources:* 273.

B [3 — Moderate] ★★★★★: USPS fleet electrification reduces long-term operating costs contributing to USPS financial instability; service reliability improvement for rural/elderly/lower-income populations most dependent on USPS for medication, financial correspondence, and package services; emissions reduction and domestic manufacturing employment (NGDV production) are secondary benefits. *Sources:* 273.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 4 / B 3

P45 — National High-Speed Rail Network

Cross-continental HSR serving as backbone for new power grid and internet infrastructure corridors.

■ Executive — Phase III major authorization

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Japan Shinkansen (3,000+ km since 1964), France TGV (2,800+ km since 1981), Germany ICE, China HSR (45,000+ km), Spain AVE, South Korea KTX — all demonstrate HSR viability at national scale with Tier A ridership, energy efficiency, and corridor revenue data; IEA: HSR substantially more energy-efficient per passenger-km than aviation. *Sources:* 26, 274.

UT [2 — Very Hard] ★☆☆☆☆: California HSR: 3–4× cost escalation (CHSRA 2025: \$126B from \$33B in 2008); FRA withdrew \$4B grant (2025); right-of-way acquisition costs 3–5× European equivalents in US litigated property system; no dedicated HSR corridor outside Northeast; interstate commerce framework requires federal authorization; aviation and auto industries benefit from passenger rail underdevelopment. *Sources:* 26, 274.

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Mode shift from aviation on 200–500 mile corridors with documented cost advantages; HSR rights-of-way provide infrastructure corridors for new power grid and internet infrastructure; reduced highway congestion costs; access to intercity transportation for populations currently served only by private automobile; primary early beneficiaries are higher-income travelers (limits B=5). *Sources:* 26, 274.

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase III · GP 5 / UT 2 / B 4

P46 — Expand Cyberwarfare Defenses

Invest heavily in domestic cyber defense; treat foreign cyberattacks as acts of war; respond with military pressure and

■ Executive — DoD/NSA directive

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: UK NCSC (est. 2016), France ANSSI, Germany BSI, Israel Unit 8200 ecosystem, NATO CCDCOE all represent institutional models with documented offensive and defensive capacity; US CYBERCOM elevated to Unified Combatant Command (2018) provides organizational framework. *Sources:* 282.

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: Expanding CYBERCOM within executive authority; bipartisan NDAA support for cyber provisions; DoD Cyberspace Workforce Strategy 2023–2027: original CMF reached FOC at 133 teams (2018), NDAA FY2022 approved expansion to 147 teams — 12 of 14 new teams established by May 2025; cybersecurity talent gap 750,000+ unfilled positions is the binding UT constraint. *Sources:* 282.

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: SolarWinds (2020), Colonial Pipeline (2021), multiple healthcare ransomware events demonstrate cyber vulnerability translates directly to population welfare harm: fuel shortages, medication delivery failures, financial disruptions; all Americans depend on resilient power, water, financial, and healthcare systems; marginal resilience improvement at scale is uniquely high-value. *Sources:* 282.

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P47 — Expand NASA & Space Force

Increase funding for space exploration and defensive space capabilities.

■ Executive — NDAA authorization

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: All major peer nations have active space programs with increasing national security components; ESA, JAXA, CSA, UK Space Agency all represent documented investment; Space Force mission has no direct international analog but space-based military capability development is universal among peer powers. *Sources: 277.*

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★☆: NDAA authorization provides legislative vehicle; NASA authorization-to-output timeline: 9-16 years for crewed vehicles; JWST: 25 years from concept to first light; UT=4 maintained because legislative authority is clear — timeline to meaningful output is long but Phase II (5-15 year) is the appropriate window. *Sources: 277.*

B [3 — Moderate] ★★★★★☆: Space exploration generates documented technology spillovers; defensive space capabilities protect GPS, communications, and satellite infrastructure on which all US economic and military activity depends; primary beneficiaries (technology spillovers, national security) are diffuse; B=3 appropriate given indirect welfare mechanism. *Sources: 277.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 4 / B 3

MILITARY & DEFENSE

P48 — Reinforce War Powers Act

Require full congressional approval for any military conflict; annual re-authorization of active conflicts.

■ Executive — Congressional resolution

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: UK Parliament Vote on Iraq (2003); Germany Bundeswehr Parlamentsbeteiligungsgesetz (2005) requires Bundestag approval for foreign deployments; Netherlands, Denmark, Finland have comparable parliamentary authorization requirements; Watson Institute: \$8T+ post-9/11 operations, none with formal declarations of war. *Sources: 156, 157.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Congressional resolution within Article I authority; Chadha (1983) invalidated legislative veto mechanism; appropriations-conditional authorization is most constitutionally durable path; bipartisan executive resistance consistent across administrations since 1973 is the primary UT barrier; GP corrected to Strong (4) in v25 from prior Partial assessment. *Sources: 157, 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: \$8T+ spent on unauthorized military engagements with documented humanitarian consequences; military service falls disproportionately on lower-income Americans — accountability for deployment is a distributionally progressive reform; WPR 48-year non-enforcement track record is itself the evidence for legislative reform. *Sources: 156, 157.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P49 — Pentagon Budget Audit Accountability

Consequences for repeated failed audits that discourage waste without gutting military readiness.

■ Executive — NDAA + IG directive

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★☆☆: UK MOD, German Bundeswehr, French DGA complete annual audits; US DoD is the only major agency of any Tier 1 government to fail annual audits for seven consecutive years (FY2018–FY2024 all disclaimers of opinion, per GAO-25-107427); no direct model for consequences-for-failure because no peer faces this situation. *Sources: 158, 283.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: NDAA provisions establishing IG directives and audit performance requirements achievable through regular authorization; GAO-25-107427 (Sept 2025): 28 material weaknesses persist DoD-wide; Financial Management Systems Modernization remediation slipped from FY2028 to FY2031; statutory mandate: clean audit by December 31, 2028 — trajectory not currently on track. *Sources: 158, 283.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: DoD IG (2023): \$247.5M duplicate payments, \$6.8B accounting adjustments without documentation, \$1.9T in assets 'cannot be verified'; consequences-for-failure framework creates incentives for system modernization; fiscal waste captured is directly available for either enhanced defense capacity or domestic investment. *Sources: 158, 283.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 4

P50 — Reduce Military Contractor Dependence

Directly hire civilians into non-combat roles; eliminate contractor middlemen inflating defense costs.

■ Executive — DoD procurement reform

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: UK MOD, German Bundeswehr, French Armée all maintain significantly higher ratios of direct government employment to contractors for non-combat functions; RAND defense studies document 1.3–1.5× cost premium for contractor provision of comparable non-combat functions; Quincy/Brown: contractors received 54% of \$4.4T Pentagon budget 2020–2024. *Sources: 148, 149.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: DoD procurement reform within executive authority for most contracting and employment decisions; major LOGCAP framework changes require NDAA action; defense contractor industry lobby (Lockheed, Raytheon, General Dynamics, KBR) significant; 3–5 year transition timeline for structured conversion programs. *Sources: 148, 149, 150.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Commission on Wartime Contracting (2011): \$31–60B lost to contractor fraud and waste in Iraq and Afghanistan alone; contractor premium 1.3–1.5× over direct employment for non-combat functions represents recoverable fiscal waste; direct government employment provides better benefits and career paths for equivalent roles. *Sources: 148, 149.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P51 — Strategic Military Workforce Pivot to Domestic Infrastructure

National Infrastructure Corps offering voluntary transition pathways for separating military personnel into energy grid,

■ Bill 4 — FSW Act (National Infrastructure Corps)

GP [3 — Partial] ★★☆☆☆: ASCE Infrastructure Report Card (2021): C- grade, \$2.6T investment gap; AmeriCorps (75,000 full-time members/yr) demonstrates federal corps scaling; ACC (launched Sept 2023): claimed 15,000 members by Sept 2024 but mostly relabeled existing positions; BLS: construction workforce gap ~430,000 workers. *Sources: 146, 147, 285.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: Bill 4/FSW provides National Infrastructure Corps provisions; ASCE: \$3.3T economic benefit from closing infrastructure gap; ACC termination by EO (January 20, 2025) demonstrates rapid reversal risk for executive-only programs — statutory protection through Bill 4/FSW is essential; veteran transition pipeline requires 3–5 year ramp. *Sources: 146, 147, 285.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Infrastructure investment multiplier 1.5–1.6 (NBER, non-recession); ASCE: closing infrastructure gap saves each household \$3,300/yr in avoided costs; veteran employment in infrastructure trades addresses both workforce gap (~430,000) and veteran underemployment; distributional impact progressive — infrastructure jobs concentrated in areas with displaced industrial workforces. *Sources: 146, 147.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase II · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 4

P52 — Multilateral Peacekeeping Coalition

Work with allied nations to form a standing peacekeeping force; reduce burden of unilateral US military deployments.

■ Executive — State Department

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: NATO collective defense framework, UN peacekeeping system, EU Common Security and Defence Policy (CSDP) all represent documented allied peacekeeping burden-sharing models; US participation in UN peacekeeping under assessed rate frameworks is established practice. *Sources: 284.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★☆☆☆: State Department executive authority for bilateral/multilateral coalition-building; UN peacekeeping budget declining (\$6.1B FY2023–24 → \$5.4B FY2025–26); US statutory 25% cap creates arrears >\$1.5B (as of April 2025); multilateral coalition building is a 5–10 year diplomatic effort; China now second largest assessed contributor at 23.785%. *Sources: 284.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: Multilateral peacekeeping reduces unilateral US burden for global stability operations; documented reduction in US casualties and equipment wear in shared deployments vs. unilateral; allied cooperation builds interoperability that increases collective security value; US arrears (\$1.5B) are a documented constraint on influence in peacekeeping governance. *Sources: 284.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

AGRICULTURE & ENVIRONMENT

P53 — Water Rights & Foreign Ownership Ban

National water ownership laws; prohibit foreign investment in domestic water and groundwater rights.

■ **Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I**

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Australia FIRB evaluates all significant foreign water rights acquisitions; EU Water Framework Directive establishes water as public good; Chile Constitutional debate (2022) centered on water rights reallocation; GAO (2024): 43.4 million acres of US agricultural land under foreign ownership, up 66% over a decade. *Sources: 160.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: CFIUS authority exists for national security review of water-adjacent agricultural land; primary gap is state-level framework consistency and national ownership registry; Bill 8/HCI provides federal model legislation; 60-vote threshold for statutory registry; water rights law is primarily state-administered requiring model legislation adoption pathway. *Sources: 160, 196.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★★: Water access is foundational to agricultural production, municipal supply, and regional economic viability; water is a non-reproducible resource in water-scarce regions; foreign acquisition permanently reduces US strategic flexibility; GAO: foreign ownership of agricultural land up 66% in a decade; distributional impact universal — water security is foundational physical welfare. *Sources: 160.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P54 — Domestic Food Priority Laws

Require minimum percentage of produce sold domestically before export.

■ **Executive — USDA rulemaking**

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★★★☆: EU export restriction powers exist for crisis situations (food security emergency provisions); some middle-income agricultural exporters use domestic supply priority requirements as standard regulation; direct Tier 1 comparator precedent at US agricultural scale is limited — GP=3 reflects partial comparability. *Sources: 162, 63.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: USDA rulemaking under Agricultural Marketing Act provides primary vehicle; but USDA REAP frozen by executive order (2025), demonstrating executive vulnerability of USDA programmatic food policy; no US implementation study found for food supply chain intervention at required scale; WTO Agricultural Agreement constraints on domestic supply priority requirements add legal complexity. *Sources: 63, 280.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: USDA ERS (2024): 12.8% of US households (17M) experienced food insecurity in 2023; US is world's largest food exporter despite this rate; FAO: countries with domestic food security buffers have 23% lower acute food insecurity during commodity price shocks; food price stabilization is most progressive in distributional impact (lower-income households spend higher income share on food). *Sources: 63, 162.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 3 / UT 3 / B 4

P55 — Protect Marine Life & Expand Aquaculture

Invest in sustainable aquaculture and marine protection; ban seafloor mining until environmental studies complete.

■ Executive — NOAA rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Norway is global leader in sustainable salmon aquaculture (government investment, research partnerships, regulatory frameworks); Australia GBRMPA integrated marine protection model; Japan and South Korea government-supported aquaculture scaling; NOAA: ocean-based industries contribute \$373B to US GDP annually. *Sources: 162, 163.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: NOAA rulemaking authority under Magnuson-Stevens is the primary vehicle; but NOAA Aquaculture Strategic Plan 2023–2028 contains NO quantitative production target; US ranks 17th–18th globally in aquaculture production with <1% of global output; 2016–2020 +50% target was missed and abandoned; seafloor mining moratorium is reversible without statutory protection. *Sources: 163.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★★: Aquaculture now accounts for 57% of seafood for human consumption globally (FAO); marine protection provides ecosystem services (storm surge mitigation, carbon sequestration); coastal fishing communities bear concentrated economic harm from stock depletion; benefit is high but trajectory uncertainty from NOAA's demonstrated implementation gap moderates score from Critical to just below. *Sources: 162, 163.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P56 — Subsidize Agricultural Electrification

Federal subsidies for farm electrification; tax incentives for transitioning agricultural equipment and processing from fossil

■ Executive — USDA/DOE grants

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: EU Common Agricultural Policy includes green investment requirements; Germany and Netherlands agricultural electrification programs; IRA (2022) USDA REAP established US framework; OECD documents peer nations investing in agricultural energy transition as standard practice. *Sources: 280.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: USDA/DOE grant authority provides implementation vehicle; REAP freeze (2025) demonstrates statutory protection needed for durability; farm equipment replacement cycle (10–15 years per machine) limits electrification pace regardless of subsidy availability; rural EV charging infrastructure is nascent; 5–10 year meaningful fleet transition. *Sources: 280.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Electric agricultural equipment operating costs lower than diesel equivalents long-term; rural agricultural communities bear disproportionate air quality costs from diesel equipment; USDA/DOE modeling documents emissions and cost-reduction trajectory; distributional benefit most progressive for family farms (less access to capital for equipment transitions). *Sources: 280.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P57 — Address Farm Labor Abuses

Enforce laws against underage and undocumented labor on farms; strengthen worker protections.

■ Executive — DOL enforcement

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: EU Seasonal Workers Directive (2014) and member-state enforcement; Canada SAWP with federal oversight; Australia Fair Work Act agricultural coverage — all provide documented frameworks with enforcement outcomes; US FLSA and MSPA (1983) provide statutory authority — gap is enforcement capacity. *Sources: 169.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: DOL Wage and Hour Division (WHD) enforcement capacity expansion within executive authority; WHD inspector staffing at historically low levels relative to regulated workforce; H-2A agricultural guest worker program creates parallel channel complicating enforcement; 1-3 year timeline for meaningfully expanded agricultural enforcement presence. *Sources: 169, 195.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: ~2.4M agricultural workers including ~70% undocumented status (least able to report violations); EPI (2022): systematic wage theft estimated at billions annually; documented physical risks (heat illness, pesticide exposure, housing deficiency); enforcement directly transfers income from violating employers to workers — strongly progressive distributional impact. *Sources: 169.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P58 — Break Up Agricultural Monopolies

Apply antitrust law to equipment monopolies; prevent market capture in agriculture.

■ Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title III

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: EU blocking of Bayer-Monsanto (2018) with structural remedy conditions; Packers and Stockyards Act authority for DOJ/USDA enforcement; Biden DOJ agriculture-specific antitrust enforcement increase (2021-2024); documented correlation between agricultural consolidation and input price increases. *Sources: 66, 163.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: Bill 3/ACFM applies repeat-violator criminal liability to agricultural sector; Packers and Stockyards Act enforcement within executive priority directive; ADM, Cargill, Tyson, JBS, Deere have significant Congressional relationships particularly in Senate agricultural states; multi-year enforcement timeline for structural market change. *Sources: 66, 196.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★☆: Agricultural consolidation imposes welfare costs on both sides: farmers face monopsony (fewer buyers, lower prices), consumers face oligopoly (fewer sellers, higher food costs); AAI documents price-cost margin expansion following consolidation; distributional impact progressive — family farmers and lower-income food consumers bear highest burden. *Sources: 66, 68.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P59 — National Climate Preparedness Corps

Consolidate FEMA and EPA functions under unified climate response mandate — environmental monitoring, disaster

■ Executive — FEMA/EPA reorganization

GP [3 — Partial] ★★★☆☆: Germany Technisches Hilfswerk (THW), Japan Cabinet Office Disaster Management, Netherlands Delta Programme for proactive climate infrastructure hardening; EU Civil Protection Mechanism; but integrated proactive-reactive climate response under unified mandate is novel design. *Sources: 285.*

UT [4 — Achievable] ★★★★★: President's Reorganization Authority allows agency restructuring with congressional notification; ACC (launched Sept 2023, claimed 15,000 members by Sept 2024) demonstrates corps scaling capacity; ACC termination by EO (Jan 20, 2025) demonstrates reversal risk — statutory framework essential; FEMA/EPA institutional coordination complexity manageable within executive authority; UT=4 maintained with durability caveat. *Sources: 285.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: NOAA documents weather/climate disasters (\$1B+ damage) increased from 7.9/yr (1980–2022 avg) to 18/yr (recent 5-year period); climate welfare burden falls disproportionately on lower-income communities with less adaptive capacity; proactive preparedness (environmental monitoring, infrastructure hardening, coordinated response) reduces both frequency and severity of welfare harm; population affected is universal. *Sources: 285.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 3 / UT 4 / B 5

P60 — Invest in Desalination Infrastructure

Federal funding for large-scale desalination plants to address long-term water scarcity.

■ Executive — DOE/Bureau of Reclamation grants

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: Israel (50%+ of freshwater from desalination); Saudi Arabia, UAE, Spain (Barcelona desalination plant) all demonstrate large-scale desalination at documented cost and output; NAS (2023): desalination costs down 80% since 1970 and continuing to decline with membrane technology. *Sources: 161.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: DOE and Bureau of Reclamation grant authority provides implementation vehicle; no new legislation required for initial investment; environmental permitting for large coastal plants is the primary implementation constraint (3–5 year NEPA process); 5–10 year timeline from investment to meaningful water supply contribution. *Sources: 161.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: Western US water scarcity is an existential risk to agriculture, municipal supply, and regional economic viability in Arizona, California, Nevada, and New Mexico; Colorado River over-allocation by 20%+ relative to current flows; desalination diversifies freshwater supply away from precipitation dependence; welfare impact is universal in affected regions. *Sources: 161.*

Score: 8.7 / 10 · Phase II · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 5

P61 — FDA Split & Reform

Separate FDA into drug regulation and food safety agencies; adopt EU food and agricultural safety standards; improve

■ Executive — HHS reorganization

GP [5 — Proven] ★★★★★: EFSA (EU Food Safety Authority) separated from EMA (European Medicines Agency) since 2002; Health Canada operates separate Drug and Food Directorates; UK MHRA/FSA separation; separation of food safety from drug regulation is the international standard — US FDA's combined structure is the outlier. *Sources: 292.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: HHS reorganization authority provides executive pathway; KFF historical analysis: major HHS sub-agency restructurings require 18-36 month minimum; HHS 2025 restructuring (partially enjoined in D. Rhode Island and N.D. California) demonstrates judicial challenge risk; FDA center-level changes typically take 2-3 years to operationalize. *Sources: 292.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: FDA food safety oversight covers 77%+ of the food supply; supplement oversight failures documented; drug approval timelines are the primary PDUFA metric — separating into dedicated agencies allows each to optimize independently; EU food and agricultural safety standards provide the baseline for the new food agency. *Sources: 292.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 5 / UT 3 / B 4

FOREIGN AFFAIRS & IMMIGRATION

P62 — Diplomatic Relationship Restoration & Strategic Investment

Systematic effort to repair damaged alliances; restore US credibility; continue support for nations under active external

■ Executive — State Department

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Post-Cold War German reunification diplomacy, post-Vietnam US diplomatic repair (1970s), Obama-era JCPOA negotiation — all document structured diplomatic restoration with measurable economic and security outcome improvements; G7 Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment provides current allied development partnership model. *Sources: 196.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★☆☆: Alliance re-engagement within executive authority — Day 1 executable; rejoining multilateral frameworks (Paris Agreement re-accession procedurally available) is near-immediate; but substantive relationships require sustained institutional behavior over multiple years; adversarial normalization (China, Russia) requires sustained engagement not reducible to Day 1 action; 1-3 year timeline for allied repair, longer for adversarial normalization. *Sources: 196.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★: US diplomatic relationships underpin multilateral frameworks governing trade, security, technology, and climate; documented allied relationship disruption imposed costs on export market access, security cooperation, pandemic preparedness, and international rules-based order; effective diplomacy is the infrastructure for every dimension of international welfare that affects American living standards and security. *Sources: 196.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

P63 — Selective & Streamlined Immigration Policy

Tighter admissions criteria paired with cleaner, faster citizenship pathway. Asylum and refugee protections maintained.

■ Executive — DHS/DOS rulemaking

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Canada Express Entry (points-based with fast processing), Australia skilled migration framework, Germany Fachkräfteeinwanderungsgesetz (2020) — all combine tighter admissions criteria with cleaner, faster citizenship pathways and documented economic integration outcomes. *Sources: 196, 197.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: DHS and DOS have significant regulatory authority within INA statutory framework; processing efficiency improvements (digitization, adjudicator staffing, asylum court capacity) within executive authority; structural visa system reform requires 60-vote threshold; USCIS backlogs exceeded 10M applications (2024); 3–5 year administrative modernization timeline. *Sources: 196, 197.*

B [4 — High] ★★★★★: USCIS backlog >10M applications creates legal limbo harm for immigrants and employer productivity loss; cleaner citizenship pathways reduce social exclusion and improve long-term integration outcomes; Canada and Australia demonstrate that structured systems produce superior economic integration outcomes relative to US current system; points-based selection improves labor market match quality. *Sources: 196, 197.*

Score: 7.3 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 4

P64 — International Property Ownership Framework

Federal model legislation and incentive structures for states to govern property acquisitions by foreign nationals — limits on

■ Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★: Australia FIRB restricts all significant foreign real estate acquisitions; Canada Investment Canada Act reviews agricultural land acquisitions; New Zealand Overseas Investment Act (2018 amendments) restricts foreign residential and agricultural purchases; GAO (2024): foreign agricultural land ownership up 66% in a decade. *Sources: 160, 281.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★: CFIUS CY2024: reviewed 325 covered transactions, issued 5 civil penalties (record, largest at \$60M) — but narrow scope confirms UT cannot support broad policy coverage claim; no implementation study found for federal model legislation at scale; 50-state adoption through incentive mechanism adds implementation complexity. *Sources: 160, 281.*

B [3 — Moderate] ★★★★★: Foreign acquisition of residential and agricultural property creates documented local welfare concerns (housing affordability, food security) but affects a meaningful subset rather than dominant share of total property transactions; CFIUS 325 transactions/yr vs. millions of total US property transactions illustrates current narrow reach; indirect welfare mechanism earns B≈3.2 rather than B=3 or B=4. *Sources: 160, 281.*

Score: 6.7 / 10 · Phase I · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 3

P65 — Nuclear Diplomacy via Allied Mediation

Broker nuclear non-proliferation agreements through allied nations whose diplomatic standing exceeds current US leverage in

■ **Executive — State Department**

GP [4 — Strong] ★★★★★☆: Norway, Finland, Switzerland: documented successful mediation traditions; Oslo Accords (Norway), Iran nuclear deal (Switzerland/EU); Bulletin of Atomic Scientists Doomsday Clock (2024): 90 seconds to midnight, closest ever; Arms Control Association: US and Russia account for ~90% of global warheads. *Sources: 153a, 154, 155.*

UT [3 — Moderate Difficulty] ★★★★★☆: State Department executive authority for multilateral mediation engagement; US direct leverage with adversarial nuclear powers is currently limited — allied-mediation model specifically addresses this gap; sustained diplomatic engagement is multi-year; Russia-Ukraine conflict and US-China tensions create challenging entry conditions. *Sources: 153a, 154.*

B [5 — Critical] ★★★★★★: Nuclear risk reduction is by definition a Critical welfare benefit — the welfare benefit of reducing existential nuclear risk is maximal; Doomsday Clock at closest ever position; US-Russia strategic stability dialogue suspended; allied mediators (Norway, Finland, Switzerland) have documented credibility that US currently lacks in key bilateral relationships; B=5 reflects the magnitude of existential risk being addressed. *Sources: 154, 155.*

Score: 8.0 / 10 · Phase II · GP 4 / UT 3 / B 5

REFORM DEMOCRATS OF THE NEW COMMONWEALTH ·

REF_RDNC_Framework_v26_Sourced_2026_5 · Sourced-Evidence Edition · Framework v26 · Scoring Methodology v1.1 · 65 Proposals · Average 7.4 · May 2026 · Project ARA 2028. Source citations reference REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11 (370 sources). Per-proposal justification paragraphs: REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026. Originally conceived and authored by a concerned American citizen. Developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). *The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.*

Source Appendix

Citations keyed to REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11 — May 2026

This appendix lists every source directly cited in this document, organized by the category structure of the Source Reference Guide (SRG v11). Categories with no citations in this document are omitted. Source numbers are stable identifiers keyed to SRG v11 — any reader may verify a source by locating its number in REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11. URLs are accurate as of the May 2026 publication date.

Source-type legend. [OECD] OECD intergovernmental data · [Gov/Agency] US government primary · [Congress] CRS reports / committee work · [Peer Review] Academic journals · [Think Tank] Research institutions · [Law/Court] Statutes / court decisions · [UN/Intl] International bodies · [NGO/Civil] Civil society research · [Industry Research] Industry-published research · [Peer Review (book)] Academic press book · [Peer Review (journal)] Academic journal article

1. Taxation & Fiscal Policy

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51	[NGO/Civil]	Endocrine Society (2023) — Gender-Affirming Care Gender-affirming medical care is evidence-based and associated with significant mental health improvements. Standard of care across peer medical institutions. endocrine.org
52	[Gov/Agency]	CDC (2022) — Contraception Statistics Contraception prevents approximately 1.7 million unintended pregnancies annually in the US. cdc.gov
53	[Peer Review]	Turnaway Study, UCSF (Foster et al.) / Gerdtts et al. (2016) Women denied wanted abortions show worse economic, health, and child welfare outcomes across 5-year follow-up period. Lead PI: Diana Greene Foster (UCSF). ansirh.org/research/research/turnaway-study
54	[Gov/Agency]	CDC (2026) — Measles Outbreak Data 4,000+ confirmed measles cases since January 2025, worst in 33 years. Three deaths confirmed. MMR kindergartner vaccination rates fell from 95.2% (2019–2020) to 92.5% (2024–2025), below herd immunity threshold. cdc.gov/measles
55	[Gov/Agency]	CBO, Single-Payer Working Paper (pub/56811, 2020) Federal subsidies under single-payer rise \$1.5–3.0T in 2030 alone. National Health Expenditure change: –\$0.7T to +\$0.3T depending on provider rates. cbo.gov/publication/56811
56	[Think Tank]	Urban Institute — Choose Medicare Act Analysis Medicare for All / public option: \$388B deficit reduction over applicable window. Lower bound of public option savings estimates. urban.org
57	[Gov/Agency]	CBO, "Add a Public Plan to the Health Insurance Exchanges" (Budget Options 2013, Option 44890) Reduces federal deficits by approximately \$158B over 10 years. cbo.gov/budget-options/2013/44890
58	[Think Tank]	RAND, Public Option Analysis (RR3153, 2020) \$7–24B/yr federal savings from public option. Colorado public option produced ~10% premium reduction in real-world implementation. rand.org
60	[Gov/Agency]	Bureau of Justice Statistics (2023) — Incarceration Rate US has highest incarceration rate globally — 608 per 100,000 vs. OECD average ~120 per 100,000. bjs.ojp.gov

61	[Think Tank]	Vera Institute (2022) — Private Prisons & Cash Bail Private prison contracts associated with higher incarceration rates and no documented cost savings after quality adjustment. vera.org
62	[Gov/Agency]	Social Security Administration Trustees Report (2024) Trust Fund projected depletion by 2035 under current policy. ssa.gov/oact/tr/2024/
63	[Gov/Agency]	USDA ERS, Food Security in the U.S. (2024) 12.8% of US households (17M) experienced food insecurity in 2023. US is the world's largest food exporter despite this rate. ers.usda.gov/topics/food-nutrition-assistance/food-security-in-the-us/

4. Economy & Labor

64	[Think Tank]	Brookings Institution (2022) — Industry Concentration Over 75% of US industries saw concentration increases over 20 years. HHI rising across manufacturing, finance, retail. brookings.edu
65	[Think Tank]	Yale School of Management (September 2024) — Competition Competitive markets increase consumer surplus, reduce deadweight loss. Comparative analysis across concentrated vs. competitive sectors. ■ QUALITY FLAG: No specific paper or author cited. Consider replacing with a specific citation in next revision. som.yale.edu
66	[NGO/Civil]	American Antitrust Institute (April 2020) Consolidation in telecom, airlines, healthcare, and agriculture produced "unprecedented levels of market concentration" with documented adverse effects on consumers and workers. antitrustinstitute.org
67	[Peer Review]	De Loecker, Eeckhout, Unger (QJE 2020) — Corporate Markups Aggregate US markups rose from 21% above marginal cost (1980) to 61% (2016), across all publicly traded US firms. The \$1.4T-in-suppressed-wages claim derives from Biden CEA analysis (Source 68) applying this research. academic.oup.com/qje/article/135/2/561/5714769
68	[Gov/Agency]	CEA, Biden White House (2021) — Competition & Labor Anticompetitive practices cost workers estimated \$1.4T in annual labor income. Market concentration reduces labor share of income across sectors. whitehouse.gov/cea
69	[Think Tank]	PIIE WP 18-4 (Furman-Orszag) — Competition & Growth Reduced competition is a significant driver of income inequality and reduced productivity growth. piie.com
70	[Gov/Agency]	CBO (2021) — Federal Minimum Wage to \$15 \$15/hr federal minimum by 2025 would raise wages for 17 million workers and lift 900,000 from poverty, at cost of approximately 1.4M jobs. cbo.gov/publication/56975

71	[Think Tank]	Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco (2020) — Minimum Wage Moderate minimum wage increases in tight labor markets produce minimal employment losses. Context-dependent analysis supporting economic-condition-indexed approach. frbsf.org
72	[Peer Review]	Dube, Lester, Reich (Review of Economics and Statistics, 2010) County-pair analysis finds minimum wage increases have no significant employment effect on low-wage service sectors. direct.mit.edu/rest/article/92/4/945/57855/
73	[Peer Review]	Cengiz et al. (Quarterly Journal of Economics, 2019) — Min Wage Meta Meta-analysis of 138 state minimum wage changes finds near-zero employment effect with documented wage gains. academic.oup.com/qje
80	[Think Tank]	KFF 2025 Employer Benefits Survey US employers spend avg \$20,143/worker on family health insurance. 12-16x disparity vs. avg \$1,054-1,254/worker on training. kff.org
81	[NGO/Civil]	ATD 2025 State of Industry — Workforce Training Average US employer training investment: \$1,054-1,254/worker annually — substantially below peer nations with public healthcare systems. td.org/research-reports
82	[OECD]	OECD Getting Skills Right (2019) Firms in countries where healthcare is publicly provided invest more in worker training than comparable firms in employer-coverage countries. 6. Legal, Governance & Civil Rights oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-skills-strategy-2019_9789264313835-en.html
131	[Gov/Agency]	NIST AI Risk Management Framework (2023) Systematic AI risks documented. Framework for AI governance and risk management. EU AI Act (2024) is the most comprehensive global framework currently in implementation. nist.gov/system/files/documents/2023/01/26/AI_RMF_1_0.pdf
132	[Gov/Agency]	DHS OIG (2019-2024) — Detention Facilities Multiple reports documenting inadequate medical care, overcrowding, and in-custody deaths in CBP and ICE facilities. 41 in-custody deaths in 2022, highest in recorded history. oig.dhs.gov
133	[Think Tank]	Harvard JCHS (2024) — Housing & Institutional Investment 12.1 million renter households severely cost-burdened (50%+ of income). Institutional investors own up to 40% of single-family rental homes in some metro submarkets. jchs.harvard.edu
134	[Think Tank]	NLIHC (2024) — Affordable Housing Shortage US faces a shortage of 7.3 million affordable homes for the lowest-income renters. nlihc.org

7. Education

135	[OECD]	OECD, Education at a Glance (Annual editions) Primary comparative education data: PISA results, per-pupil spending, attainment rates, and tuition comparisons across member nations. oecd.org/en/topics/education-at-a-glance.html
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136	[OECD]	OECD PISA (2023) — International Education Rankings US 15-year-olds rank 28th in reading and 35th in mathematics among OECD nations. Finland, Estonia, South Korea, Japan consistently top-ranked. oecd.org/pisa/
137	[Think Tank]	McKinsey Global Institute (2009) — Education Achievement Gap Closing US educational achievement gap with top-performing nations would add 3–5% to GDP annually — cumulative \$40–100T over following decades. mckinsey.com/industries/education
138	[Law/Court]	UK Age Appropriate Design Code / EU Digital Services Act (2022) UK Children's Code (2021): restricts behavioral profiling, targeted advertising, and nudge techniques for users under 18. EU DSA minor protection provisions. Three-tier structure in DRDO Act Title V modeled on UK Children's Code. ico.org.uk/childrens-code
143	[Law/Court]	Chile Law 20.606 (2016) / Taillie et al. (PLOS Medicine 2020) Chile food marketing restriction: 24% reduction in calories from sugar-sweetened beverages. Most rigorously evaluated advertising restriction globally. journals.plos.org/plosmedicine/
144	[Peer Review]	Boyland et al. (JAMA Pediatrics 2022) — Food Marketing Meta-Analysis 96 studies confirm food marketing increases caloric intake and HFSS food choice. Dhar-Baylis (J. Marketing Research 2011): Quebec ban reduced fast-food purchase propensity 13%/week. jamanetwork.com/journals/jamapediatrics
145	[Law/Court]	UK Health and Care Act 2022 — HFSS Advertising Ban 9pm watershed + 24hr online HFSS ad ban (enforcement January 2026). Estimated 20,000 fewer childhood obesity cases. legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2022/31

8. Military & Defense

146	[NGO/Civil]	ASCE Infrastructure Report Card (2021) Infrastructure investment gap \$2.6T over 10 years, C– grade. ASCE estimates \$3.3T economic benefit from closing the infrastructure gap. infrastructurereportcard.org
147	[Gov/Agency]	BLS (2024) — Construction Workforce Gap Construction workforce gap of ~430,000 workers. Veteran underemployment in infrastructure trades documented as a transition gap. bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/
148	[Gov/Agency]	Commission on Wartime Contracting (2011) \$31–60B lost to contractor fraud and waste in Iraq and Afghanistan alone. wartimecontracting.gov
149	[Think Tank]	Quincy Institute / Brown University Costs of War (2025) Military contractors received 54% of \$4.4T Pentagon budget 2020–2024 (\$2.4T). Top 5 contractors received \$771B. watson.brown.edu/costsofwar/

150	[Gov/Agency]	GAO-23-106123 — DoD Service Contracts / POGO Contractor Cost Analysis GAO-23-106123: DoD service contracts \$184-226B/yr flagged as high-risk. The 1.83x contractor-vs-federal-employee cost ratio is from a separate POGO analysis (also referenced under this source number). gao.gov/products/gao-23-106123
154	[Think Tank]	Bulletin of Atomic Scientists, Doomsday Clock (2024) 90 seconds to midnight — closest ever. Global nuclear risk at highest since Cold War. US-Russia strategic stability dialogue suspended. thebulletin.org
155	[NGO/Civil]	Arms Control Association Fact Sheet (2024) 9 countries hold nuclear weapons. US and Russia account for ~90% of warheads. Global nuclear risk context for nuclear diplomacy proposals. armscontrol.org/factsheets/
156	[Think Tank]	Watson Institute Costs of War (2023) \$8T+ spent on post-9/11 operations. None had formal declarations of war. Used for War Powers Act reform scoring. watson.brown.edu/costsofwar/
157	[Congress]	Congressional Research Service (R42699, 2021) — War Powers The WPR's 48-year track record of non-enforcement is itself the evidentiary basis for reform. Presidents have deployed forces without authorization in multiple theaters since 1973. everycrsreport.com/reports/R42699.html
158	[Gov/Agency]	DoD Inspector General (2023) — Pentagon Audit \$247.5M in duplicate payments, \$6.8B in accounting adjustments without documentation, \$1.9T in assets that 'cannot be verified.' dodig.mil

9. Agriculture & Environment

160	[Gov/Agency]	GAO (2024) — Foreign Agricultural Land Ownership 43.4 million acres of US agricultural land under foreign ownership as of 2021, up 66% over a decade. gao.gov
161	[Think Tank]	National Academy of Sciences (2023) — Desalination Costs Desalination costs have fallen 80% since 1970 and continue declining with membrane technology improvements. nationalacademies.org
162	[UN/Intl]	FAO Food and Agriculture State Report (2023) Countries with domestic food security buffers have 23% lower acute food insecurity rates during global commodity price shocks. Aquaculture now accounts for 57% of seafood for human consumption globally. fao.org/world-food-situation/
163	[Gov/Agency]	NOAA Fisheries Stock Assessment (2024) 46 stocks subject to overfishing or overfished. Ocean-based industries contribute \$373B to US GDP annually. fisheries.noaa.gov/national/population-assessments/fish-stock-sustainability-index

- 169** [Think Tank] **Economic Policy Institute (2022) — Farm Worker Wage Theft**
Undocumented farm workers face systematic wage theft estimated at billions annually. Limited recourse due to status vulnerability.
[epi.org](https://www.epi.org)

14. Scoring Methodology Reference Sources

- 192** [OECD] **OECD, Health at a Glance (Annual) [Methodology Ref]**
Primary comparative health data for GP scoring of all healthcare-related proposals. International precedent verification across 38+ OECD member countries. [Methodology cross-reference; see also Source 39]
oecd.org/en/topics/health-at-a-glance.html
- 194** [OECD] **OECD, Tax Administration Series (Annual) [Methodology Ref]**
Primary comparative tax administration data. Pre-filing rates, e-filing rates, and compliance infrastructure across 58+ jurisdictions. [Methodology cross-reference; see also Source 1]
oecd.org/tax/forum-on-taxadministration/
- 195** [Gov/Agency] **GAO, High Risk List (Annual) [Methodology Ref]**
Primary reference for US Transition difficulty (UT) scores on proposals involving federal agency reform. Identifies agencies with documented management deficiencies. [Methodology cross-reference; see also Source 96]
gao.gov/highrisk/overview
- 196** [Congress] **Congressional Research Service (CRS) Reports — Various [Methodology Ref]**
Used throughout for US legislative history, constitutional analysis, and US Transition scoring. CRS reports cited: War Powers (R42699); Tax Gap (R47858); Federal Tax Gap Overview (IF11887). [Methodology cross-reference]
congress.gov/crs-products
- 197** [UN/Intl] **World Bank, Governance Indicators [Methodology Ref]**
Cross-national comparison of regulatory quality, rule of law, and government effectiveness when establishing GP precedent scores for governance reform proposals. [Methodology cross-reference] 18. UT Implementation Research — Phase 3 (Audit 5, May 2026)
worldbank.org/en/publication/worldwide-governance-indicators
- 272** [Gov/Agency] **GAO-25-108502 (May 2025) + DOT OIG AV2025036 (July 2025) — FAA NextGen**
Modernization FAA spent >\$15B on NextGen FY2007–2025; delivered only ~16% of projected benefits. 76% of 138 ATC systems unsustainable. DOT OIG: completion pushed to 2030+. New '\$31.5B ATC System' planning estimate.
gao.gov/products/gao-25-108502
- 273** [Gov/Agency] **USPS OIG Fleet Modernization Audit (2024) + USPS 10-Year Strategic Plan**
NGDV program: \$9.6B total, 106,000 vehicles including ≥66,000 BEVs. ~9 years from program start to first deliveries (~3× original plan). Only ~2,500 NGDVs delivered by Nov 2025.
uspsoig.gov/reports/audit-reports/fleet-modernization-delivery-vehicle-acquisition-status
- 274** [Gov/Agency] **NEC Commission CONNECT NEC 2035 + FTA Hudson Tunnel Quarterly Monitoring**
Report Q2 June 2025 \$117B 15-year, 150-project NEC capital plan with ~\$100B funding gap. Gateway Program: Hudson Tunnel total cost \$16.041B; new tunnel scheduled to open 2035.
transit.dot.gov

276	[Gov/Agency]	OPM Time-to-Hire Dashboard FY2024 + DOL Top Management Challenges Report (2022) OPM FY2024 governmentwide average time-to-hire: 101 days. DOL: 5 years to fully train an operational OSHA inspector. OSHA inspector headcount fell from 860 (2014) to 750 (2021) — all-time low. opm.gov
277	[Gov/Agency]	CRS IF11643 — Artemis Program (NASA); JWST Artemis: traced to NASA Authorization Act 2010; Artemis I launched Nov 2022 (12 years); cost ~\$93B through 2025. JWST: concept 1996 → launch Dec 2021 (~25 years); final cost ~\$10B (10× original estimate). congress.gov/crs-product/IF11643
278	[Gov/Agency]	NOAA Aquaculture Strategic Plan 2023-2028 NOAA 5-year plan articulates four qualitative goals but deliberately omits any numerical production-scaling target. US ranks 17th–18th globally, <1% of global production. 2016–2020 plan set a +50% goal that was missed; not carried forward. fisheries.noaa.gov/feature-story/noaa-announces-5-year-strategic-plan-aquaculture
280	[Gov/Agency]	USDA AMS Packers and Stockyards Division Annual Report FY2021-2022 (published March 2024) 108–110 employees overseeing ~5,900 regulated entities. \$11.6M/\$11.1M in recoveries. No FY2023 or FY2024 standalone report published as of April 2026 — significant transparency gap. ams.usda.gov/reports/psd-annual-reports
281	[Gov/Agency]	Treasury CFIUS Annual Report to Congress CY2024 (released August 2025) 325 covered transactions. 78% declaration clearance rate (record high). Five civil penalties — record — including largest single penalty in CFIUS history at \$60 million. China: 28 notices. home.treasury.gov/policy-issues/international/cfius
282	[Gov/Agency]	DoD Cyberspace Workforce Strategy 2023-2027 + CYBERCOM Expansion Data (DefenseScoop, May 2025) Original Cyber Mission Force reached FOC May 2018 at 133 teams. FY2022 NDAA approved expansion to 147 teams. As of May 2025, 12 of 14 new teams established. CYBERCOM cyber budget FY2024: \$13.5B. dodemergingtech.com/dod-cyber-workforce-strategy-2023-2027
283	[Gov/Agency]	GAO-25-107427 — DoD Financial Management: Status of Remediation Efforts (Sept 2025) FY2024: DoD received disclaimer of opinion for the seventh consecutive year (\$4.1T assets, \$4.3T liabilities). 28 material weaknesses persist DoD-wide. Statutory mandate: clean audit by December 31, 2028. gao.gov/products/gao-25-107427
284	[Gov/Agency]	CRS IF10597 — United Nations Issues: U.S. Funding to the UN System (updated April 2024) US assessed peacekeeping rate: 26.94% (2022–2024). Total UN peacekeeping arrears ~\$1.5B by April 2025. UN peacekeeping budget declining: \$6.1B FY2023–24 → \$5.4B FY2025–26. congress.gov/crs-product/IF10354

285	[Gov/Agency]	AmeriCorps State and National (CRS IF12983, 2024) + American Climate Corps Scaling and Termination Data AmeriCorps: ~75,000 full-time members/yr; FY2024 appropriation >\$1.2B. ACC (launched Sept 2023): claimed 15,000 members by Sept 2024 but most were relabeled existing positions. Terminated by EO January 20, 2025. congress.gov/crs_external_products/IF/HTML/IF12983.html
286	[Gov/Agency]	Norges Bank Investment Management (NBIM) Annual Report 2024 — Norway Government Pension Fund Global Fund value end-2024: NOK 19,742B (~\$1.78T USD). Authorized 1990, first deposit 1996, surpassed \$1T September 2017 (~13 years from first inflows). 2024 return 13.1%; long-term average 6.64% since 1998. Management cost: 0.04% of AUM. nbim.no/en/publications/reports/2024/annual-report-2024
287	[Think Tank]	Connecticut CT Baby Bonds Program (CT Treasurer, 2023-2024) + Urban Institute 'Modeling Impacts of Federal Baby Bonds' (Dec 2024) CT program: \$3,200/Medicaid birth; ~13,300 enrolled first 9 months. Urban Institute DYNASIM: projected age-18 balances \$26K (Black), \$27K (Hispanic), \$18K (white). CRFB estimates federal cost ~\$60B/yr. portal.ct.gov/ott/newsroom
288	[Gov/Agency]	CBO Publication 60679 — Long-Term Projections for Social Security (2024) OASI trust fund depletion: end of FY2033. 75-year actuarial imbalance: 4.3% of taxable payroll. After-depletion benefits: 77% of scheduled. Solvency options: raise payroll tax from 12.4% to 16.2%; or cut benefits 24%. cbo.gov/publication/60679
289	[Gov/Agency]	DEA Cannabis Rescheduling Timeline 2020-2026 (Federal Register, DOJ Press Releases, CRS LSB11105) HHS scheduling recommendation: August 30, 2023. DEA NPRM: May 21, 2024. DOJ partial final order: April 23, 2026 — placing only FDA-approved products and state-medical-licensed marijuana in Schedule III. Full rescheduling hearing: June 29–July 15, 2026. Total: 32+ months and still incomplete. federalregister.gov/documents/2024/06/11/2024-12706
290	[Gov/Agency]	Tennessee Promise Evaluation (TN Comptroller OREA, 2024) + THEC Enrollment Data 150,000+ enrolled since 2014; cost ~\$4,537/student/yr community college; FY2024 first-to-second-semester success rate 83.8% (all-time high). 28 state promise programs nationally. comptroller.tn.gov/content/dam/cot/orea/advanced-search/2024/TNPromise2024Fullreport.pdf
291	[Gov/Agency]	DOL ETA WOTC Program Data (FY2023) + Registered Apprenticeship Expansion FY2014–FY2024 WOTC FY2023: 1,918,901 certifications; authorization EXPIRED Dec 31, 2025. Registered Apprenticeship: ~680,000 active apprentices FY2024 (up 114% from ~318,000 in FY2014); average entry wage \$18/hr, exit \$32/hr (+77%). dol.gov/agencies/eta/wotc

292	[Gov/Agency]	HHS Reorganization 2025 — Press Release (March 27, 2025) + KFF Analysis + Litigation Status (April 2026) HHS: 82,000→62,000 FTE (~25% cut); 28 divisions consolidated to 15. Implementation 13 months in: partially blocked by injunctions (D. Rhode Island, N.D. California); 19 states + DC suing. KFF historical analysis: major HHS sub-agency restructurings require 18-36 months minimum. hhs.gov/press-room/hhs-restructuring-doge.html
293	[Gov/Agency]	FTC Rulemaking Timeline Data — Negative Option / Click-to-Cancel (Oct 2024, vacated July 2025) + Commercial Surveillance ANPR (Aug 2022, stalled) + FY2024 Enforcement Report Click-to-Cancel: ANPR Oct 2019 → Final Oct 2024 (~5 years) → VACATED by 8th Circuit July 8, 2025. Commercial Surveillance ANPR: Aug 22, 2022 → NPRM never issued → ~3.7 years stalled. Average major FTC commercial rulemaking: 5+ years ANPR-to-final. ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/rules/negative-option-rule
294	[Gov/Agency]	ATF NFA Processing Timeline Data — eForms Relaunch (2021) + Post-2024 Process Changes + OBBBA Impact (2026) Post-eForms relaunch Dec 2021 + March 2024 non-FIFO process change: eForm 4 individual ~4-10 days, trust ~22 days. OBBBA (P.L. 119-21, July 4, 2025) eliminated \$200 NFA tax stamp for suppressors/SBRs/SBSs/AOWs effective Jan 1, 2026. atf.gov
295	[Peer Review]	Maryland HQL Implementation + Crifasi et al. (2017, RSF Journal) + Doucette, Crifasi et al. (Injury Epidemiology, 2024) Maryland Firearm Safety Act of 2013 effective Oct 1, 2013. Crifasi (2017): 82% reduction in police recovery of handguns with strong diversion indicators in Baltimore. Doucette (2024): 32.3% reduction in firearm injury hospitalization rates. ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC11342609
296	[Gov/Agency]	FBI NICS 2024 Operational Report + BSCA 2022 Enhanced Provisions Implementation + Fix NICS (2018) Record Uploads Brady Act signed Nov 30, 1993 → NICS launched Nov 30, 1998 (~5 years). BSCA (June 2022) enhanced under-21 provisions: operational Jan 4, 2023 (6 months). 2024 NICS: 91.95% immediate determination rate; ~39.7M annual checks; >500M cumulative; >2M cumulative denials. fbi.gov/file-repository/2024-nics-operational-report.pdf

Scoring Methodology Note

All proposal scores in this document are derived using **REF_RDNC_ScoringMethodology_2026 v1.1**. That document is the authoritative methodological reference for the three-axis scoring framework (GP / UT / B) applied throughout. The scoring formula is **(GP + UT + B) / 1.5**, producing a score on a 1-10 scale. Each axis is scored 1-5 against formal rubrics defined in the Methodology document. **GP** (Global Precedent) evaluates international evidence strength and transferability. **UT** (US Transition Difficulty) evaluates implementation feasibility across four sub-dimensions: legislative/constitutional feasibility, implementation timeline, US precedent and scaling evidence, and agenda synergy. **B** (Societal Benefit) evaluates population-wide welfare outcomes with explicit progressive weighting. The **calibrated conservatism** principle applies throughout: where evidence is ambiguous or insufficient, the lower score is assigned. Optimism requires substantiation. For full rubrics, calibration examples, comparator nations, evidence quality tiers, and documented limitations, see REF_RDNC_ScoringMethodology_2026 v1.1.

***REF_RDNC_Framework_v26_Sourced_2026_5** · Source Appendix · Framework v26 · Scoring Methodology v1.1 · Source Reference Guide v11 · May 2026 · Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth · Project ARA 2028. Developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.*